



Making inroads: Manav Suthar (left) claimed eight wickets in the second four-day game with his left-arm spin.

challenging conditions.

The series also offered a glimpse of Australia's next line of Test hopefuls. Head coach Tim Paine had emphasised it as preparation for the 2027 Test tour of India. Off-spinner Todd Murphy, wicketkeeper-batter Josh Philippe, and all-rounder Cooper Connolly showcased the skills and temperament to push for a return to the longer format. Philippe, in particular, adapted impressively to the tempo of red-ball cricket, compiling 212 runs with a blend of aggression and patience — evidence that he could yet evolve beyond his white-ball label.

The pitches added another layer of

intrigue. The first match was high-scoring, rewarding stroke-making and attacking intent. The second slowed slightly but never became treacherous, testing batters to adjust rhythm and shot selection. Australian batters often attacked rather than defended, forcing India A's bowlers, who leaned too heavily on conventional "good areas," to rethink their plans. The relentless heat and humidity tested all players, with umbrellas and towels frequently rushed onto the field.

Challenging contests

In the bigger picture, the series served its purpose. India A found reassurance in Rahul, confirmation in Sudharsan and Jurel, and promise in Brar and Suthar. It also highlighted areas for growth, particularly the need for greater bowling intensity against fearless opponents. Australia

Steady and sparkling: India A found reassurance in K.L. Rahul, while Sudharsan sealed his promise as series top-scorer with 248 runs.

A, despite leaving without a win, gained invaluable experience.

Philippe's growth, McSweeney's composure, and collective acclimatisation to Indian conditions will stand them in good stead for future subcontinental tours.

The 1-0 scoreline barely tells the story. Across two four-day games, India A and Australia A braved heat and humidity, trading moments of brilliance and flashes of vulnerability. What began as preparation became a proving ground for established stars, emerging talents, and anyone looking to stake a claim in the Tests to come.

Most runs

Player (Team)	M	Inn	Runs	Ave.	100s	50s	HS
B. Sai Sudharsan (India A)	2	3	248	82.66	1	2	100
Josh Philippe (Australia A)	2	3	212	106	1	1	123 not out
Dhruv Jurel (India A)	2	3	197	65.66	1	1	140

Most wickets

Player (Team)	M	Inn	Wkts	Ave.	Best figures
Gurnoor Brar (India A)	2	3	8	25.50	3/42
Manav Suthar (India A)	1	2	8	19.62	5/107
Corey Rocchiccioli (Australia A)	2	3	6	44.50	3/159

India A clinches ODI series



India A clinched the three-match unofficial ODI series 2-1 after Prabhsimran Singh's blazing 68-ball 102 powered a thrilling two-wicket win over Australia A in the decider in Kanpur. Earlier, centuries from Shreyas Iyer and Priyansh Arya had set up a commanding 171-run victory in the opening game, before Jack Edwards starred with bat and ball to guide Australia A to a nine-wicket win in a rain-hit second match. The finale, though, belonged to India A, which chased down 317 in style to seal the series.